
SORTEDEA.CLUB · FIELD GUIDE

Save it as a skill

Turn the document you built about your principal into something that works without being remembered.

01 Executive Playbook

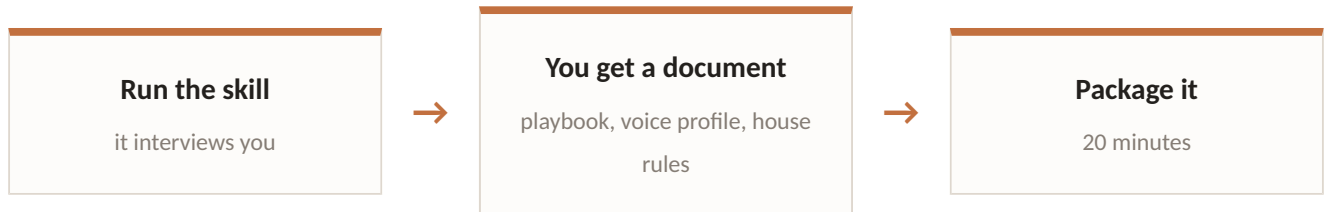
02 Executive Voice

03 LinkedIn

ONE

The idea

Three SortedEA skills hand you a document. A document has to be remembered. A skill does not.



From then on it applies itself, every time you work on your principal's behalf.

YOU NEED

- Any Claude plan, with code execution on. Free, Pro and Max: **Settings** → **Capabilities**. Team and Enterprise: **Organization settings** → **Skills**.
- The ability to make a folder and a zip file. That is the whole technical requirement.

IF YOU CANNOT SEE THE OPTION TO ADD A SKILL

Your organisation has turned off user-created skills. That is an administrator setting, not a fault. Ask before you spend an afternoon on it.

TWO

How to build one

The same six steps for all three. Read this page once.

1. MAKE THE FOLDER

```
voice-jchen/  
├─ SKILL.md           rules, read every time  
└─ references/  
    ├─ samples.md     read only when needed  
    └─ log.md          read only when needed
```

Everything in `SKILL.md` loads every time. References sit on disk until something needs them. So short rules go in the first, long lists and examples in the second.

2. WRITE THE TOP OF SKILL.MD

```
---  
name: voice-jchen  
description: How J Chen writes. Apply when drafting anything  
            going out under their name.  
---
```

FIELD	LIMIT	RULES
name	64 chars	Lowercase, numbers and hyphens. No capitals, spaces or underscores. Cannot contain <i>claude</i> or <i>anthropic</i> .
description	200 chars	The only thing Claude reads to decide whether to use the skill. Use the words you actually type.

NO COLONS IN THE DESCRIPTION

A colon breaks the settings block. The skill then fails to load with no error and no warning. It simply never fires.

3. TURN THE DOCUMENT INTO INSTRUCTIONS

- **Imperative, not descriptive.** "Mean sentence length 14 words" becomes "keep sentences short, around 14 words".
- **Keep the numbers.** They are what make it better than a hunch.
- **Mark the strength.** **HARD** never break it. **STRONG** most of the time. Everything else is a preference.

- **Point at the references** so they get read: "*when a draft feels wrong, read references/samples.md.*"

4. END WITH THESE TWO LINES

Never change a fact to match a preference. No softening a decline, no committing them to something they did not say.

Do not force every pattern in. If it reads as an imitation, use fewer of them.

5. INSTALL

- 1 **Zip the folder**, not the files inside it.
- 2 **Customize → Skills → Add → Upload a skill.**
- 3 **Switch it on.** Uploading and enabling are two different things.

Using Claude Code instead? Drop the folder into `~/.claude/skills/`.

6. KEEP IT ALIVE

Every time your principal changes something you drafted, add it to `references/log.md`. Once a quarter, anything that has happened three times becomes a rule. Fifteen minutes.

THREE

Executive Playbook

The operating file becomes a skill. The private annex never does.

```
name: playbook-jchen
description: How J Chen works. Read before scheduling, booking travel
            or drafting on their behalf.
```

IN SKILL.MD

- Scheduling rules, and who gets through
- Working hours and protected time
- Communication preferences
- Travel preferences
- How they decide
- Emergency procedure
- Confidentiality rules

IN REFERENCES

- Restaurants, gifts, vendors
- Food and drink detail
- The corrections log

NEVER INCLUDE

Anything from the private annex. Date of birth, home address, family, doctor, loyalty numbers, passport.

The skill may say "*passport details are in the annex, ask me*". It may not contain them.

KEEP THE TAGS

Act on `[said]` directly. Flag `[observed]` when the stakes are high. Treat `[inherited]` as a rumour.

And the rule that matters most: when the playbook does not cover something, say so and ask. Never invent a preference.

TEST IT

Ask five things you know the answer to. Then ask something it does not cover, and check it says so.

Executive Voice

The one that pays back fastest, because drafting happens every day.

```
name: voice-jchen
description: How J Chen writes. Apply when drafting anything going out
            under their name, or checking a draft sounds like them.
```

IN SKILL.MD

- The three-line summary
- Sentence lengths, with the numbers
- Greetings and sign-offs, with counts
- Words they use and avoid
- Punctuation, including what never appears
- How they decline, chase, disagree
- What changes by audience
- The hard nos

IN REFERENCES

- Every verbatim sample
- The corrections log

When a draft comes out wrong, three real sentences fix it faster than any amount of analysis. But they do not need to be in context every time.

NEVER INCLUDE

Unstripped samples. Replace names, figures and clients with placeholders before packaging.

"Can you get me the [figure] before [day]?" carries the voice and discloses nothing.

TEST IT

Write three short pieces. Mix them with three real ones. Ask a colleague who knows your principal which are real.

If they pick yours out instantly, ask what gave it away. That answer is the rule you are missing.

LinkedIn

Not how LinkedIn works. What *this* principal will and will not say in public.

```
name: linkedin-jchen
description: J Chen's LinkedIn house rules. Use when drafting a post
or deciding whether something should be posted.
```

IN SKILL.MD

- The subjects they have authority on
- **The no-go list.** Usually the most useful section
- How their public voice differs from email
- The two or three post shapes that work
- Who publishes, and how
- Whose posts they engage with

IN REFERENCES

- Posts that worked, and did not
- The corrections log

PUT THIS LINE IN THE SKILL

Since 2026 LinkedIn demotes what it calls "AI slop", meaning content that sounds polished but has no point of view. So the failure mode has flipped. It is no longer sounding wrong. It is **sounding fine and saying nothing**.

If there is no specific claim, number, named example or genuine opinion in this, do not write the post. Say there is nothing to post this week.

NEVER INCLUDE

Their login. Signing in as your principal breaches LinkedIn's User Agreement, and the account holder is responsible for everything that happens through the account.

Record the route instead: they publish, or an authorised scheduling tool does.

Five privacy rules

All three describe a named real person, built from their private material. That makes them different from every other skill you will install.

- 1 **Never publish it.** No public repository, no skills directory, no marketplace.
- 2 **Never share it organisation-wide.** The button is right there. This is not one of those.
- 3 **Strip it again before packaging.** Names, figures, clients, anything about a third person.
- 4 **Tell your principal it exists.** They agreed to a document, not to something that runs automatically.
- 5 **Delete it when you leave.** Not yours to take.

THE TEST THAT CATCHES MOST MISTAKES

Before a line goes in, ask: **if this were forwarded to the wrong person tomorrow, which lines would I regret?**

Move those to the annex. If you would regret them there too, do not write them anywhere.

WHEN IT DOES NOT WORK

Nine times out of ten the fix is one added sentence, not a rebuild. Open the skill, highlight the part that is wrong, click **Edit with Claude**.

WHAT YOU SEE

WHAT IS WRONG

It never fires	The description, not the body. Check for a colon. Use the words you actually type.
Nothing happens	Uploaded but not switched on.
Upload rejected	You zipped the files, not the folder.
Name rejected	Capitals, spaces, underscores, or the reserved words.
Reads as a parody	Every pattern applied at full force. Add the strength labels.
It invents things	Add the instruction to ask rather than guess.
Right facts, wrong feel	The samples are not being read. Point at them explicitly.

One page

- 1 Folder named `playbook-jchen` , `voice-jchen` or `linkedin-jchen` .
- 2 `SKILL.md` inside. Name matching the folder, description under 200 characters, no colon.
- 3 Rules in the body. Numbers kept, strength labels kept.
- 4 Long lists and samples in `references/` , with a line telling Claude when to read them.
- 5 Zip the folder. Upload. Switch it on.
- 6 Test against something you have already done.
- 7 Log every correction. Promote the repeats each quarter.

WHAT NEVER GOES IN

SKILL	EXCLUDED
<code>playbook-*</code>	The whole private annex
<code>voice-*</code>	Unstripped samples
<code>linkedin-*</code>	Their login, anything not yet public
All three	Passwords. And none of them is ever published or shared org-wide.

Platform details come from Anthropic's own help pages, checked 31 August 2026. If your screen disagrees, your screen is right. LinkedIn quotations come from LinkedIn's help pages and User Agreement, same date.

The tiering, the tags and the naming convention are ours, not official guidance. Adapt them to whatever your organisation requires for material about a named person.

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